# Luca Henkel

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## Research Interests

Behavioral Economics, Household Finance

## Employment

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| 2024 – | **Assistant Professor of Finance**, Erasmus University Rotterdam |
| 2023 – 24 | Postdoctoral Scholar, University of Chicago and University of CEMA |

## Education

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| 2016 – 23 | Ph.D. in Economics *(summa cum laude)*, University of Bonn |
| 2016 – 17 | Visiting Ph.D. Student, University of California, Berkeley |
| 2016 – 20 | M.Sc. in Economics *(with distinction)*, University of Bonn |
| 2013 – 16 | B.Sc. in Economics *(with distinction)*, University of Bonn |

## Affiliations

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| Director | Joint Initiative for Latin American Experimental Economics (JILAEE) |
| Network Affiliate | CESifo Research Network |
| Research Affiliate | IZA@LISER - Institute of Labor Economics |
| Research Fellow | Tinbergen Institute |
| Associate Member | Erasmus Research Institute of Management (ERIM) |
| Senior Fellow | Microsoft AI Economy Institute |

## Short-term Research Visits

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|---|---|
| 2026 | Becker Friedman Institute for Economics, University of Chicago |
| 2025 | Department of Economics, University of Chicago |
| 2025 | FAIR Centre, Norwegian School of Economics |

## Publications

**Eliciting Moral Preferences under Image Concerns: Theory and Experiment** Paper
with Roland Bénabou, Armin Falk and Jean Tirole
*Games and Economic Behavior*, 2026

**Proud to Not Own Stocks: How Identity Shapes Financial Decisions** Paper
with Christian Pugnaghi-Zimpelmann
*The Review of Financial Studies, 2026*

**Experimental Evidence on the Relationship between Perceived Ambiguity and Likelihood Insensitivity** Paper
*Games and Economic Behavior, 2024*

**Historical narratives about the COVID-19 pandemic are motivationally biased** Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz, Robert Böhm, and Cornelia Betsch
*Nature, 2023*

**The association between vaccination status identification and societal polarization** Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz, Lars Korn, Cornelia Betsch and Robert Böhm
*Nature Human Behaviour, 2023*

**Different interventions for COVID-19 primary and booster vaccination? Effects of psychological factors and health policies on vaccine uptake** Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz, Robert Böhm and Cornelia Betsch
*Medical Decision Making, 2023*

**Payments and freedoms: Effects of monetary and legal incentives on COVID-19 vaccination intentions in Germany** Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz and Cornelia Betsch
*PLOS ONE, 2022*

## Working Papers

**Identity as Self-Image** Paper
with Roland Bénabou
*Handbook of the Economics of Identity*, Forthcoming

**The Role of Interpersonal Uncertainty in Prosocial Behavior** Paper
with Anujit Chakraborty
*American Economic Review*, Reject and Resubmit

**Ends versus Means: Kantians, Utilitarians, and Moral Decisions** Paper
with Roland Bénabou and Armin Falk
*The Economic Journal*, Revise and Resubmit

**Limited Self-knowledge and Survey Response Behavior** Paper
with Armin Falk, Thomas Neuber, and Philipp Strack

**Cues, Attention, and Charitable Giving** Paper
with Christoph Oslislo and Frederik Schwerter

**Voice AI in Firms: A Natural Field Experiment on Automated Job Interviews** Paper
with Brian Jabarian

**Understanding and mitigating climate policy polarisation** Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz, Cornelia Betsch, and Robert Böhm

## Policy Writings

**Identification, polarization, and their societal and political consequences** Paper
with Robert Böhm, Philipp Sprengholz, and Cornelia Betsch
*United Nations Human Development Report 2023-24, 2024*

**Personal motivations polarize people's memories of the COVID-19 pandemic** Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz
*Nature, 2023*

**Learning from the past? How biased memories of the pandemic endanger preparation for future crises** Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz, Robert Böhm, and Cornelia Betsch
*Clinical and Translational Medicine, 2023*

**Wie die Pandemie zu Polarisierung und gesellschaftlicher Destabilisierung beiträgt**
with Cornelia Betsch, Philipp Sprengholz, and Robert Böhm
*Multiple Krisen der Gegenwart, 2025* [Link to book]

## Teaching

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| 2026 | Seminar Behavioral Finance (Undergraduate, EUR, rating 4.2/5‡) |
| 2025 | Minor Behavioral Finance (Undergraduate, EUR, rating 4.3/5‡) |
| 2025 | Seminar Interest Rates and the Stock Market (Undergraduate, EUR, rating 4.5/5‡) |
| 2024 | Minor Behavioral Finance (Undergraduate, EUR, rating 4.1/5‡) |
| 2022 | Course Behavioral Economics (Undergraduate, UBonn, rating 1.5/5*) |
| 2021 – 22 | Research Module in Management and Applied Micro (Graduate, UBonn, unrated) |
| 2020 – 21 | Seminar Scientific Work Methods (Undergraduate, UBonn, rating 1.1/5*) |

‡ *Erasmus University Rotterdam: 5 represents the best grade.*
* *University of Bonn: 1 represents the best grade.*

## Conferences and Seminars

*Conferences: ♦Presenter; ◊Discussant; *Participant*

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| 2027 | *Invited seminars:* University of Antwerp \| University of Cologne \| Università Cattolica Milan<br>*(scheduled)* |
| 2026 | *Invited seminars:* Paris School of Economics \| University of Gothenburg \| University of Glasgow \| University of Tokyo \| Utrecht University<br>*Conferences:* Behavioral Approaches to Financial Decision-Making Conference◊ \| Early-Career Behavioral Economics Conference* \| EFA Annual Meeting 2026◊ \| ERINN Conference♦ \| New Frontiers in Behavioral Research Workshop* \| Recent Advances in Behavioral Economics Workshop♦ \| Workshop on Cognitive Economics♦ \| 5th Workshop on Field Experiments in Economics and Business♦ \| 11th Maastricht Behavioral Economic Policy Symposium♦<br>*(includes scheduled)* |

2025 *Invited seminars:* Erasmus School of Economics | University of Amsterdam | University of Chicago | University of Cologne | University of Konstanz | RWI Essen
*Conferences:* AI at Work Retreat* | CESifo Area Conference on Behavioral Economics♦ | CESifo Workshop on the Economic and Societal Impacts of AI♦ | Early-Career Behavioral Economics Conference* | 17th Maastricht Behavioral and Experimental Economics Symposium♦ | SFI-SCG Corporate Social Responsibility Workshop◊ | 2025 World Congress of the Econometric Society♦ | Zeuthen Workshop on Cognitive Foundations of Economic Decision-making♦

2024 *Invited seminars:* Berlin Behavioral Economics Seminar | UC Davis | Cornell University | London School of Economics | Middlebury College | ODISSEI | University of Chicago | University of Chicago Booth School of Business | Universidad Torcuato Di Tella | University of Zürich
*Conferences:* Bay Area Behavioral and Experimental Economics Workshop♦ | Early-Career Behavioral Economics Conference♦ | Workshop on Beliefs, Narratives, and Memory♦

2023 *Invited seminars:* Bocconi University | Development Bank of Latin America and the Caribbean (CAF) | Carnegie Mellon University | Erasmus School of Economics | Goethe University Frankfurt | NYU Abu Dhabi | Rotterdam School of Management | University of CEMA | University of Essex | University of San Andrés
*Conferences:* Bonn-Frankfurt-Mannheim PhD Conference♦ | CESifo Area Conference on Behavioral Economics♦ | ERINN Conference♦ | LACEA Annual Meeting* | SAFE Household Finance Workshop♦ | SEHO Annual Meeting♦

2018 – 22 *Conferences:* briq Summer School in Behavioral Economics | Bonn-Mannheim PhD Conference♦ | 6th CRC TR 224 Conference♦ | 10th CRC TR 224 Conference♦ | EEA Annual Congress♦ | ESA Global Conference♦ | SEF Experimental Finance Conference♦ | VfS Annual Conference♦

## Professional Service

Conference Organizer
*Early-Career Behavioral Economics Conference (ECBE):* IZA, Bonn (2024); NHH, Bergen (2025); Booth School of Business, Chicago (2026); University of Zurich, Zurich (2027)
*Chicago School in Experimental Economics (CSEE)*: University of Chicago (2024); University of Chicago (2025); IZA and University of Bonn (2025); University of Osaka (2026); University of CEMA (2026)
*Erasmus Early-Career Finance Retreat* (2026); Erasmus University Rotterdam
*Workshop in Behavioral and Experimental Economics* (2026); Universidad Di Tella
*Bonn-Mannheim PhD Conference* (2020); University of Bonn

Seminar Organizer
ERIM Field Experiments Seminar (2025 – present, Erasmus University Rotterdam)
Applied Micro Coffee Seminar (2019 – 2022, University of Bonn)

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| Refereeing | *Economics:* American Economic Review \| Econometrica \| Economic Journal \| Economics Letters \| European Economic Review \| Experimental Economics \| Games and Economic Behavior \| Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization \| Journal of Economic Psychology \| Journal of Political Economy \| Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics \| Journal of Public Economics \| Journal of the European Economic Association \| Journal of Human Resources \| Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics \| Management Science \| Review of Economics and Statistics<br>*Other:* British Journal of Health Psychology \| Humanities and Social Sciences Communications \| Self and Identity<br>*Conferences:* EFA Annual Meeting 2024, EFA Annual Meeting 2026, VfS Annual Conference 2026<br>*Grants:* UK Research and Innovation Research Grant |
| Hiring Committee | Erasmus University Rotterdam (AP) 23/24, 24/25 \| JILAEE (Postdoc) 23/24, 24/25, 25/26 \| University of Chicago (Postdoc) 24/25, 25/26 |
| Other | Award Committee, Advances with Field Experiments Conference (2025); Member of the selection committee, German Academic Exchange Service (2019) |

## Grants

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| | **Total: ≈ $520,000**; As PI: **≈ $425,500** |
| PI | *Projects:* Schmidt Sciences AI at Work Research Grant ($200,000) \| University of Chicago Research Grant ($23,875) \| Schmidt Sciences Proposal Development Award ($10,000) \| CRC TR 224 Research Grant (23,737€, multiple projects) \| Selten Seeding Grant (15,800€, multiple projects) \| ECONtribute Research Grant (4,820€) \| IZA Research Grant (3,250€) \| Young ECONtribute Program Grant (1,032€)<br>*Conferences:* ECBE funding (77,440€, multiple sources) \| CSEE funding (45,000€, multiple sources) |
| Co-PI | *Projects:* Microsoft AI Economy Institute Research Grant ($94,500) |

## Awards and Scholarships

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| 2023 | Finalist for the Distinguished CESifo Affiliate Award in Behavioral Economics |
| 2017 – 20 | Dissertation Scholarship, Bonn Graduate School of Economics |
| 2016 – 17 | Scholarship for Graduates, German Academic Exchange Service |
| 2014 – 18 | Merit Scholarship, Friedrich Ebert Foundation |

## Media Mentions

Ärztezeitung | Berliner Kurier | Bloomberg | Business Insider | Chicago Booth Review Podcast | Der Standard | El Espectador | FAZ | Financial Times | Focus | Fortune | Huff Post | Knowable Magazine | Kurier | Latest Thinking | Marginal Revolution | MDR | MedPage Today | NDR | ORF | Poets & Quant | Salzburger Nachrichten | Spiegel | Springer Professional | Süddeutsche | SWR | Sydney Morning Herald | Tagesschau | Tagesspiegel | TF1 | The Fast Company | The Information | Toronto Star | VOL | Wiener Zeitung | WirtschaftsWoche | Zeit

## Miscellaneous

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| Citizenship | German |
| Languages | German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (beginner) |

Last update: September 18, 2026